

UNION TERRITORIES

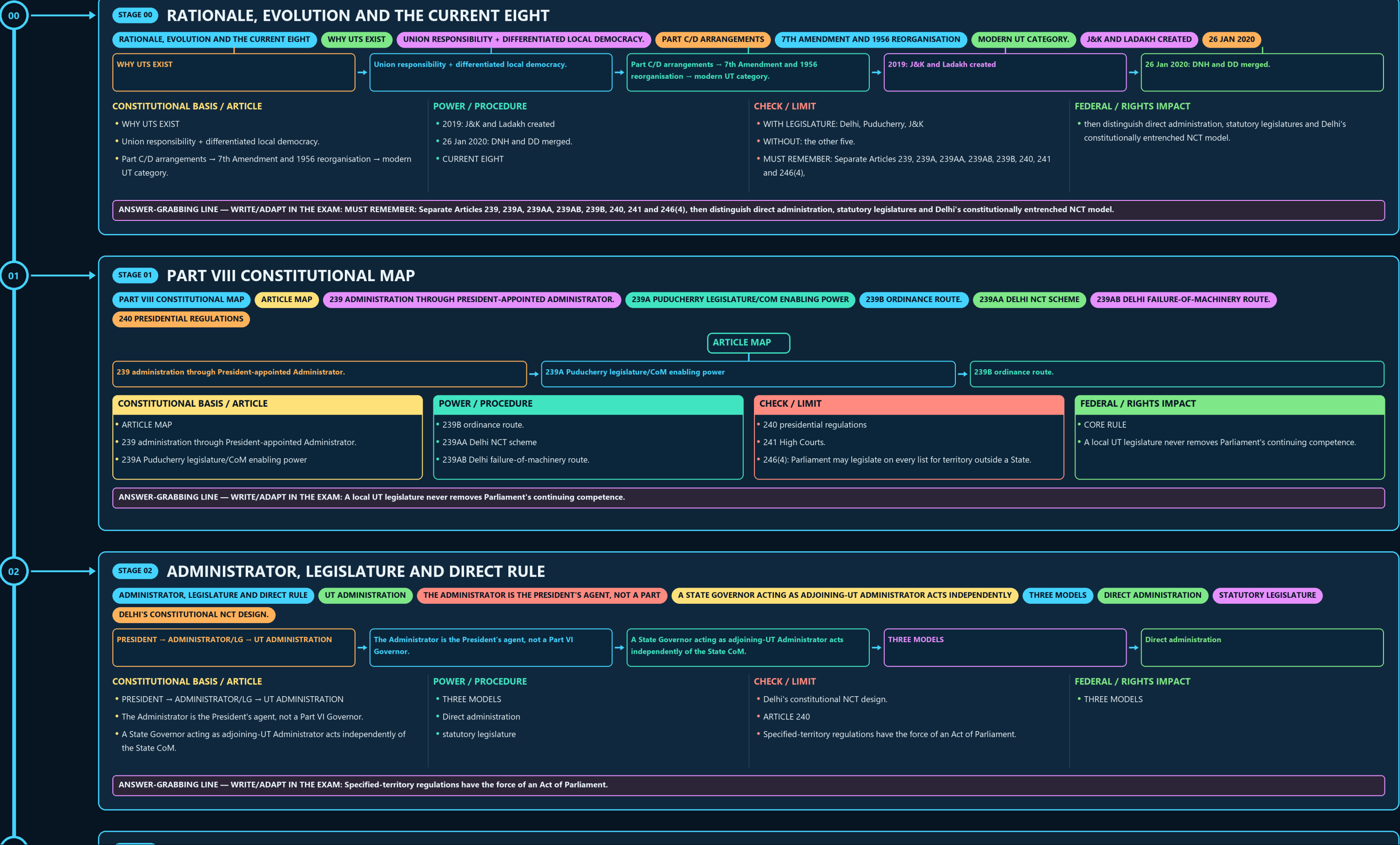
RATIONALE, EVOLUTION AND THE → PART VIII CONSTITUTIONAL MAP → ADMINISTRATOR, LEGISLATURE AND DIRECT → HIGH COURTS AND LEGISLATURE-FREE → DELHI ARTICLE 239AA DESIGN → DELHI CASES, SERVICES AND

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g6 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



02

STAGE 02 ADMINISTRATOR, LEGISLATURE AND DIRECT RULE

ADMINISTRATOR, LEGISLATURE AND DIRECT RULE

UT ADMINISTRATION

THE ADMINISTRATOR IS THE PRESIDENT'S AGENT, NOT A PART

A STATE GOVERNOR ACTING AS ADJOINING-UT ADMINISTRATOR ACTS INDEPENDENTLY

THREE MODELS

DIRECT ADMINISTRATION

STATUTORY LEGISLATURE

DELHI'S CONSTITUTIONAL NCT DESIGN.

PRESIDENT → ADMINISTRATOR/LG → UT ADMINISTRATION

The Administrator is the President's agent, not a Part VI Governor.

A State Governor acting as adjoining-UT Administrator acts independently of the State CoM.

THREE MODELS

Direct administration

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- PRESIDENT → ADMINISTRATOR/LG → UT ADMINISTRATION
- The Administrator is the President's agent, not a Part VI Governor.
- A State Governor acting as adjoining-UT Administrator acts independently of the State CoM.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- THREE MODELS
- Direct administration
- statutory legislature

CHECK / LIMIT

- Delhi's constitutional NCT design.
- ARTICLE 240
- Specified-territory regulations have the force of an Act of Parliament.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- THREE MODELS

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Specified-territory regulations have the force of an Act of Parliament.

03

STAGE 03 HIGH COURTS AND LEGISLATURE-FREE UTs

HIGH COURTS AND LEGISLATURE-FREE UTs

HIGH COURT MAP

DELHI HC

J&K + LADAKH

COMMON J&K AND LADAKH HC.

PUNJAB & HARYANA

WITHOUT LEGISLATURE

DIRECT UNION ADMINISTRATION STILL COEXISTS WITH MPS, COURTS, LOCAL

HIGH COURT MAP

Delhi → Delhi HC

J&K + Ladakh → common J&K and Ladakh HC.

A&N → Calcutta

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- HIGH COURT MAP
- Delhi → Delhi HC
- J&K + Ladakh → common J&K and Ladakh HC.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- A&N → Calcutta
- Chandigarh → Punjab & Haryana
- DNHDD → Bombay.

CHECK / LIMIT

- Lakshadweep → Kerala
- Puducherry → Madras.
- WITHOUT LEGISLATURE

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Direct Union administration still coexists with MPs, courts, local bodies and legal remedies.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Direct Union administration still coexists with MPs, courts, local bodies and legal remedies.

04

STAGE 04 DELHI ARTICLE 239AA DESIGN

DELHI ARTICLE 239AA DESIGN

DELHI NCT

69TH AMENDMENT 1991

ARTICLE 239AA

ASSEMBLY + COM + LG.

ASSEMBLY FIELD

STATE AND CONCURRENT LISTS EXCEPT ENTRIES 1, 2 AND

RESERVED CORE

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

DELHI NCT
69th Amendment 1991 → Article 239AA → Assembly + CoM + LG.

POWER / PROCEDURE

ASSEMBLY FIELD
State and Concurrent Lists except Entries 1, 2 and 18, plus related 64, 65 and 66.

CHECK / LIMIT

Reserved core: public order
Aid and advice is the rule inside the allotted field.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

LG reference to President is exceptional, not routine.
Parliament retains overriding competence; Article 239AB is the breakdown route.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- DELHI NCT
- 69th Amendment 1991 → Article 239AA → Assembly + CoM + LG.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- ASSEMBLY FIELD
- State and Concurrent Lists except Entries 1, 2 and 18, plus related 64, 65 and 66.

CHECK / LIMIT

- Reserved core: public order
- Aid and advice is the rule inside the allotted field.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- LG reference to President is exceptional, not routine.
- Parliament retains overriding competence; Article 239AB is the breakdown route.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Aid and advice is the rule inside the allotted field.

05

STAGE 05 DELHI CASES, SERVICES AND STATUTORY RESPONSE

DELHI CASES, SERVICES AND STATUTORY RESPONSE

GNCTD AID-AND-ADVICE JUDGMENT (2018)

REPRESENTATIVE GOVERNMENT AND AID/ADVICE PREVAIL WITHIN DELHI'S ALLOTTED FIELD.

DELHI SERVICES JUDGMENT (2023) — 11 MAY

ENTRY 41 SERVICES FOLLOWED ELECTED ACCOUNTABILITY OUTSIDE THE RESERVED

ACT 19 OF 2023

NCCSA RECOMMENDS TRANSFERS/POSTINGS; LG HAS STATUTORY FINAL SAY ON

28 AUGUST 2026 CONTROL

GNCTD aid-and-advice judgment (2018)

Representative government and aid/advice prevail within Delhi's allotted field.

Delhi services judgment (2023) — 11 MAY

Entry 41 services followed elected accountability outside the reserved fields.

ACT 19 OF 2023

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- GNCTD aid-and-advice judgment (2018)

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Entry 41 services followed elected accountability outside the reserved fields.

CHECK / LIMIT

- 28 AUGUST 2026 CONTROL

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- J&K excludes public order and police

69th Amendment 1991 → Article 239AA → Assembly + CoM + LG.	State and Concurrent Lists except Entries 1, 2 and 18, plus related 64, 65 and 66.	Aid and advice is the rule inside the allotted field.	Parliament retains overriding competence; Article 239AB is the breakdown route.
CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE • DELHI NCT • 69th Amendment 1991 → Article 239AA → Assembly + CoM + LG.	POWER / PROCEDURE • ASSEMBLY FIELD • State and Concurrent Lists except Entries 1, 2 and 18, plus related 64, 65 and 66.	CHECK / LIMIT • Reserved core: public order • Aid and advice is the rule inside the allotted field.	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT • LG reference to President is exceptional, not routine. • Parliament retains overriding competence; Article 239AB is the breakdown route.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Aid and advice is the rule inside the allotted field.			

05

STAGE 05 DELHI CASES, SERVICES AND STATUTORY RESPONSE			
DELHI CASES, SERVICES AND STATUTORY RESPONSE	GNCTD AID-AND-ADVICE JUDGMENT (2018)	REPRESENTATIVE GOVERNMENT AND AID/ADVICE PREVAIL WITHIN DELHI'S ALLOTTED FIELD.	DELHI SERVICES JUDGMENT (2023) — 11 MAY
ENTRY 41 SERVICES FOLLOWED ELECTED ACCOUNTABILITY OUTSIDE THE RESERVED	ACT 19 OF 2023	NCCSA RECOMMENDS TRANSFERS/POSTINGS; LG HAS STATUTORY FINAL SAY ON	28 AUGUST 2026 CONTROL
GNCTD aid-and-advice judgment (2018)	Representative government and aid/advice prevail within Delhi's allotted field.	Delhi services judgment (2023) — 11 MAY	Entry 41 services followed elected accountability outside the reserved fields.
ACT 19 OF 2023			
CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE • GNCTD aid-and-advice judgment (2018) • Representative government and aid/advice prevail within Delhi's allotted field. • Delhi services judgment (2023) — 11 MAY	POWER / PROCEDURE • Entry 41 services followed elected accountability outside the reserved fields. • ACT 19 OF 2023 • NCCSA recommends transfers/postings; LG has statutory final say on disagreement.	CHECK / LIMIT • 28 AUGUST 2026 CONTROL • The Act remains operative; pending constitutional challenge is not invalidation. • CLOSE DISTINCTION: Delhi excludes State List Entries 1, 2 and 18 plus related 64-66	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT • J&K excludes public order and police • Puducherry's statutory competence is over List II/III matters insofar as applicable to Union Territories. • Parliament retains overriding UT competence.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Delhi excludes State List Entries 1, 2 and 18 plus related 64-66; J&K excludes public order and police; Puducherry's statutory competence is over List II/III matters insofar as applicable to Union Territories. Parliament retains overriding UT competence.			

06

STAGE 06 PUDUCHERRY STATUTORY MODEL			
PUDUCHERRY STATUTORY MODEL	ARTICLE 239A + GOVERNMENT OF UNION TERRITORIES ACT 1963	STATUTORY ASSEMBLY + COM; PARLIAMENT RETAINS UT-WIDE POWER.	ARTICLE 239B ORDINANCE REQUIRES PRIOR PRESIDENTIAL INSTRUCTIONS.
CENTRAL NOMINATION OF UP TO THREE MEMBERS UPHELD; NOMINEES	ARTICLE 240	REGULATION POWER IS UNAVAILABLE DURING NORMAL ASSEMBLY FUNCTIONING.	K. LAKSHMINARAYANAN (2018)
Statutory Assembly + CoM; Parliament retains UT-wide power.	Article 239B ordinance requires prior presidential instructions.	K. LAKSHMINARAYANAN (2018)	
CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE • ARTICLE 239A + GOVERNMENT OF UNION TERRITORIES ACT 1963 • Statutory Assembly + CoM; Parliament retains UT-wide power.	POWER / PROCEDURE • Article 239B ordinance requires prior presidential instructions. • K. LAKSHMINARAYANAN (2018)	CHECK / LIMIT • Central nomination of up to three members upheld; nominees possess voting rights. • ARTICLE 240	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT • Regulation power is unavailable during normal Assembly functioning. • It revives during constitutionally qualifying suspension or dissolution.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: It revives during constitutionally qualifying suspension or dissolution.			

07

STAGE 07 JAMMU AND KASHMIR AND LADAKH AFTER 2019			
JAMMU AND KASHMIR AND LADAKH AFTER 2019	J&K REORGANISATION ACT 2019 — EFFECTIVE 31 OCTOBER	UT WITH LEGISLATURE	UT WITHOUT LEGISLATURE.
BUDGET, LEGISLATION AND EXECUTIVE ACCOUNTABILITY OPERATE UNDER THE ACT	ELECTED ASSEMBLY AND COM FUNCTION AFTER 2024; STATEHOOD NOT	J&K ASSEMBLY	STATE/CONCURRENT COMPETENCE EXCEPT PUBLIC ORDER AND POLICE; LAND IS
J&K REORGANISATION ACT 2019 — EFFECTIVE 31 OCTOBER	J&K → UT with legislature	Ladakh → UT without legislature.	J&K ASSEMBLY
State/Concurrent competence except public order and police; land is not generally excluded.			
CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE • J&K REORGANISATION ACT 2019 — EFFECTIVE 31 OCTOBER • J&K → UT with legislature	POWER / PROCEDURE • Ladakh → UT without legislature. • J&K ASSEMBLY	CHECK / LIMIT • State/Concurrent competence except public order and police; land is not generally excluded. • Budget, legislation and executive accountability operate under the Act and rules.	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT • Elected Assembly and CoM function after 2024; Statehood not restored by 5 Sep 2026. • Ladakh has no legislature; safeguard demands are proposals, not enacted status.
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Ladakh has no legislature; safeguard demands are proposals, not enacted status.			

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: It revives during constitutionally qualifying suspension or dissolution.

07

STAGE 07 JAMMU AND KASHMIR AND LADAKH AFTER 2019

JAMMU AND KASHMIR AND LADAKH AFTER 2019 J&K REORGANISATION ACT 2019 — EFFECTIVE 31 OCTOBER UT WITH LEGISLATURE UT WITHOUT LEGISLATURE. J&K ASSEMBLY STATE/CONCURRENT COMPETENCE EXCEPT PUBLIC ORDER AND POLICE; LAND IS

BUDGET, LEGISLATION AND EXECUTIVE ACCOUNTABILITY OPERATE UNDER THE ACT ELECTED ASSEMBLY AND COM FUNCTION AFTER 2024; STATEHOOD NOT

J&K REORGANISATION ACT 2019 — EFFECTIVE 31 OCTOBER

J&K → UT with legislature

Ladakh → UT without legislature.

J&K ASSEMBLY

State/Concurrent competence except public order and police; land is not generally excluded.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- J&K REORGANISATION ACT 2019 — EFFECTIVE 31 OCTOBER
- J&K → UT with legislature

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Ladakh → UT without legislature.
- J&K ASSEMBLY

CHECK / LIMIT

- State/Concurrent competence except public order and police; land is not generally excluded.
- Budget, legislation and executive accountability operate under the Act and rules.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Elected Assembly and CoM function after 2024; Statehood not restored by 5 Sep 2026.
- Ladakh has no legislature; safeguard demands are proposals, not enacted status.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Ladakh has no legislature; safeguard demands are proposals, not enacted status.

08

STAGE 08 DELHI, PUDUCHERRY AND J&K COMPARED

DELHI, PUDUCHERRY AND J&K COMPARED CONSTITUTIONAL ARTICLE 239AA EXCLUDES PUBLIC ORDER, POLICE, LAND. ARTICLE 239A + 1963 ACT LIST II/III MATTERS INSOFAR AS APPLICABLE TO UTs. 2019 ACT + ARTICLE 239A APPLICATION EXCLUDES PUBLIC ORDER AND POLICE. ALL THREE

DELHI	constitutional Article 239AA	excludes public order, police, land.
PUDUCHERRY	Article 239A + 1963 Act	List II/III matters insofar as applicable to UTs.
J&K	2019 Act + Article 239A application	excludes public order and police.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- constitutional Article 239AA
- excludes public order, police, land.
- Article 239A + 1963 Act

POWER / PROCEDURE

- List II/III matters insofar as applicable to UTs.
- 2019 Act + Article 239A application
- excludes public order and police.

CHECK / LIMIT

- ALL THREE
- Assembly + CoM + Administrator/LG; Parliament retains overriding UT competence.
- DO NOT FLATTEN

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Legal source, nominated membership, services control and referral rules differ.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Legal source, nominated membership, services control and referral rules differ.

09

STAGE 09 FRICTION, ACCOUNTABILITY AND REFORM

FRICTION, ACCOUNTABILITY AND REFORM WHY FRICTION OCCURS SPLIT LEGISLATIVE FIELD + DIVIDED OFFICER CONTROL + REFERRAL/OVERRIDE ACCOUNTABILITY TEST EXACT FIELD COURT REMEDY. CLARIFY RESERVED FIELDS BOUND REFERRALS

WHY FRICTION OCCURS

Split legislative field + divided officer control + referral/override powers.

ACCOUNTABILITY TEST

Exact field → decision-maker → staff/finance → override → court remedy.

Clarify reserved fields

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- WHY FRICTION OCCURS
- Split legislative field + divided officer control + referral/override powers.
- ACCOUNTABILITY TEST

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Exact field → decision-maker → staff/finance → override → court remedy.
- Clarify reserved fields
- bound referrals

CHECK / LIMIT

- align officers with accountability.
- Publish reasons and timelines
- preserve judicial review

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- date every current claim.
- Union safeguards are strongest when narrow, reasoned and democratically accountable.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Union safeguards are strongest when narrow, reasoned and democratically accountable.

10

STAGE 10 PYQS, CASE LAW AND CLOSE-OPTION TRAPS

PYQS, CASE LAW AND CLOSE-OPTION TRAPS PYQ 2018 GS-II Q11 ARTICLE 239AA 2018 RATIO SERVICES SEQUEL OPERATIVE 2023 ACT PYQ 2025 GS-II Q4 2019 ACT

PYQ 2018 GS-II Q11

Article 239AA → 2018 ratio → services sequel → operative 2023 Act → verdict.

PYQ 2025 GS-II Q4

2019 Act → J&K Assembly field/functions → LG/Parliament limits → Statehood caveat.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- PYO 2018 GS-II Q11

POWER / PROCEDURE

- 2019 Act → J&K Assembly field/functions → LG/Parliament limits → Statehood

CHECK / LIMIT

- Delhi services iudament (2023).

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- 239AB != 239B

powers.

remedy.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- WHY FRICTION OCCURS
- Split legislative field + divided officer control + referral/override powers.
- ACCOUNTABILITY TEST

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Exact field → decision-maker → staff/finance → override → court remedy.
- Clarify reserved fields
- bound referrals

CHECK / LIMIT

- align officers with accountability.
- Publish reasons and timelines
- preserve judicial review

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- date every current claim.
- Union safeguards are strongest when narrow, reasoned and democratically accountable.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Union safeguards are strongest when narrow, reasoned and democratically accountable.

10

STAGE 10

PYQS, CASE LAW AND CLOSE-OPTION TRAPS

PYQS, CASE LAW AND CLOSE-OPTION TRAPS

PYQ 2018 GS-II Q11

ARTICLE 239AA

2018 RATIO

SERVICES SEQUEL

OPERATIVE 2023 ACT

PYQ 2025 GS-II Q4

2019 ACT

PYQ 2018 GS-II Q11

Article 239AA → 2018 ratio → services sequel → operative 2023 Act → verdict.

PYQ 2025 GS-II Q4

2019 Act → J&K Assembly field/functions → LG/Parliament limits → Statehood caveat.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- PYQ 2018 GS-II Q11
- Article 239AA → 2018 ratio → services sequel → operative 2023 Act → verdict.
- PYQ 2025 GS-II Q4

POWER / PROCEDURE

- 2019 Act → J&K Assembly field/functions → LG/Parliament limits → Statehood caveat.
- CASE CONTROLS
- GNCTD aid-and-advice judgment (2018).

CHECK / LIMIT

- Delhi services judgment (2023).
- K. Lakshminarayanan (2018).
- In Re: Article 370 of the Constitution (2023).

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- 239AB != 239B
- Chandigarh not Article 240-listed
- Delhi exclusions != J&K exclusions.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Article 239AA → 2018 ratio → services sequel → operative 2023 Act → verdict.

11

STAGE 11

EXAM ANSWER SPINE AND CURRENT FIREWALL

EXAM ANSWER SPINE AND CURRENT FIREWALL

ANSWER SPINE

CLASSIFY MODEL

EXACT ARTICLE/STATUTE

LOCAL DEMOCRATIC MECHANISM.

ADD UNION SAFEGUARD

INSTITUTIONAL FRICTION

CALIBRATED REFORM.

ANSWER SPINE

Classify model → exact Article/statute → local democratic mechanism.

Add Union safeguard → institutional friction → case/year → calibrated reform.

EVIDENCE METHOD

Claim → named authority → mechanism → dated control → limitation → verdict.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ANSWER SPINE
- Classify model → exact Article/statute → local democratic mechanism.
- Add Union safeguard → institutional friction → case/year → calibrated reform.
- EVIDENCE METHOD
- Claim → named authority → mechanism → dated control → limitation → verdict.

POWER / PROCEDURE

- CURRENT FIREWALL — 28 AUGUST 2026
- 8 UTs
- 3 legislatures
- J&K elected but still UT.
- GNCTD Act 2023 operative

CHECK / LIMIT

- challenge unresolved
- proposal is not law.
- A UT legislature is real self-government, but not State-equivalent autonomy.
- LEGAL/SOURCE LIMIT: India has eight Union Territories and three legislatures: Delhi,
- Puducherry and J&K.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- J&K has an elected government but remains a UT
- Ladakh has no legislature.
- Act 19 of 2023 remains operative while the Delhi services constitutional challenge is unresolved.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Claim → named authority → mechanism → dated control → limitation → verdict.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

PART A — CREATION & LIST

PART B — ADMINISTRATION (ART 239–241)

PART C — SPECIAL STATUS OF DELHI (ART 239-AA)

J&K AND LADAKH CREATED 2019 BY THE J&K REORGANISATION

DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI AND DAMAN & DIU MERGED

TOTAL DROPPED FROM 9 TO

CURRENT 8

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE

- PART A — CREATION & LIST
- PART B — ADMINISTRATION (Art 239–241)
- PART C — SPECIAL STATUS OF DELHI (Art 239-AA)
- J&K and Ladakh created 2019 by the J&K Reorganisation Act (J&K with legislature, Ladakh

ADVANCED LIMIT

- Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu merged into a single UT on 26 Jan 2020 → total dropped from 9 to
- Current 8: A&N Islands · Chandigarh · DNH & Daman & Diu · Delhi (NCT) · J&K · Ladakh · Lakshadweep ·
- LG: Delhi, Puducherry, A&N, J&K, Ladakh. Administrator: Chandigarh, DNH-DD, Lakshadweep.
- President may appoint a state Governor as administrator of an adjoining UT (acts independently of his

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- CM appointed by the President (not the LG); ministers hold office during President's pleasure.
- On a difference between LG and ministers, the LG refers the matter to the President .
- President's Rule provision resembles Art 356 .
- SC (May 2023): the elected Delhi government has control over services (admin control over officers),

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.